

IN4MATX 232: Research in HCI

Class 15:
Subcommittee Grab Bag

Daniel Epstein

Disclaimer

- I have greater knowledge about some of the subcommittees we will discuss today than others
- Interrupt me whenever. This will go better if I answer your questions

Computational Interaction

Computational Interaction

- Considers interaction with heavily computational systems
- Foundation emerged out of the latest wave of AI/Machine Learning
- Therefore, the work might study people's lived experiences with ML models
- Or design new tools for effective/useful interaction with them

Computational Interaction

- Some overlap with Intelligent User Interfaces (IUI)
- Some overlap with FAccT community (Fairness, Accountability, Transparency, and Ethics in AI)
- Like everything else at CHI, needs to be human-centered in goals, evaluation, etc.

Computational Interaction

- IUI prioritizes technical innovation over human needs with AI systems
 - You won't see an empirical study of how people use LLMs for X at IUI
 - Both framing papers discuss the “role of AI” in human-centered systems, and therefore make more sense at CHI

Specific Application Areas and COMPASS

Specific Application Areas

- Building knowledge about how to design, build, deploy, or study technology for a particular group or domain
- Most of the areas we talked about this quarter “grew out” of specific application areas
 - Health, accessibility, learning/education/families, privacy & security, critical & sustainable computing
 - More subcommittees may still grow out of this subcommittee

COMPASS

- Co-sponsored between SIGCHI and SIGCAS (Computers and Society)
- Conference on **Computing and Sustainable Societies**
- Used to be the ACM Computing for Development (DEV) conference

COMPASS

- Frequent friction between research contributors and who the research purportedly seeks to benefit
 - E.g., researchers are frequently American/European, but work often targets the Global South
- Sustainability and marginalization get grouped together

Visualization

Visualization

- Everything pertaining to data visualization (graphs, charts, etc.)
- New techniques for visualizing data, tools for creating visualizations, evaluations of how visualizations are perceived
- Needs to have a “human” component, can’t just be technical innovation

Visualization

- Some overlap with the IEEE InfoVis community, e.g. the “Vis” conference
- IEEE InfoVis has a variety of work less relevant to HCI
 - Technical work, like computational approaches to visualizing big data
 - Scientific visualizations, in partnership with biology groups and whatnot

Games and Play

Games and Play

- Everything playful interaction
- Can be the design of games, playful interaction, study of player and developer communities

Games and Play

- Specific conference
 - CHI Play
- Still a relatively new community within HCI
- My understanding from UCI's Games scholars is that the community isn't well-connected with Games Studies scholarship yet

Alternatively: the catch-all subcommittees

The catch-all subcommittees

- CHI has multiple subcommittees whose goal are to ensure that every piece of work that is HCI has a home at CHI
- They often overlap with some of the more specialized subcommittees, both in people and in topics
- Some have explicit methodological focus, but are pretty wide-ranging in the topics they cover

The catch-all subcommittees

- Understanding People: Theory, Concepts, Methods
- User Experience and Usability
- Specific Application Areas
- Design

Understanding People: Theory, Concepts, Methods

Understanding people: Theory, Concepts, Methods

- Where the main goal is understanding how people use some technology
 - Largely empirical contributions
 - But some other contributions: “theory”, “concepts”, “methods”
- Split committee based on *how* people are being “understood”
 - Qualitative, quantitative, mixed/alternative (??)

Understanding people: Theory, Concepts, Methods

- No specialized conference on Understanding People, to my knowledge

User Experience and Usability

User Experience and Usability

- Where the main goal is understanding how to promote good user experiences
 - Same as understanding people: largely empirical, some more theoretical
- I don't understand this subcommittee very well
 - Its reviewer pool is largely European
 - To me, all of the work fits just as well under some other subcommittee

User Experience and Usability

- No dedicated conference, as far as I know
- Presumably some overlap with professional organizations like UXPA, but it's not really leveraged

Specific Application Areas

Reflections on catch-all subcommittees

Reflections

- In general, if your work is relevant to a specialized subcommittee, I'd recommend submitting there over a catch-all subcommittee
 - More likely that your methods and arguments will be recognized and appreciated
- There is serious overlap
 - In the past, some papers have appeared on multiple subcommittee's lists of "example" papers

Reflections

- We have a tendency to get stuck in our topical bubbles, so these subcommittees offer a nice reprieve
- It's fun to read and review papers from these subcommittees, to appreciate the breadth of HCI

Final Advice

Final Advice

- Much of subcommittee's preferences are socially constructed
- Lean on others to decide which subcommittee to submit to
 - We give advice every year at the CHI bootcamp
- The hope is that your paper will get a fair review regardless of whether the subcommittee match is perfect or not
 - Of course, your mileage may vary

IN4MATX 232: Research in HCI

Class 15:
Subcommittee Grab Bag

Daniel Epstein